Q+A

# STORIES FROM LIFE

*Veteran actor **Ashish Vidyarthi** speaks about* Kahanibaaz, *his live storytelling show which will travel to the US in March*

**Q. What led you to create 'Kahanibaaz'?**

While doing stand-up comedy, I realised there were tales I had that people loved listening to. People would tell me that my stories were inspiring. Last December, I was invited to open for a show at the Royal Opera House in Mumbai. I narrated my story for about 20 minutes. That's when I knew that I was ready for 'Kahanibaaz'.

**Q. What sets it apart?**

I am a writer of tales—of talks which are reflections of a life lived. 'Kahanibaaz' is one reflection, with stories that are a tribute to my life, people I've met, and the experiences I've had. They are about how each one of us is uniquely broken, and how uniquely we have created something amazing with our lives.

**Q. You are an actor, standup comic, motivational speaker and influencer. How do you don different hats with ease?**

I don't balance roles. I love to create and everything happens organically. When people speak about brand dilution, I say I am a celebration of it and it's not always a bad thing. As I dilute myself, I flow from one thing to another.

**Q. What are the other projects you are working on?**

I'm currently working on a mix of films and series across platforms and languages, including *Bandwaale* on Prime Video, *Raakaasa* (Telugu), *Hawks*, *Balaramana Dinagalu* (Kannada) and *Storm*, which marks Hrithik Roshan's OTT production debut.

*—with **Deepa Natarajan Lobo***

